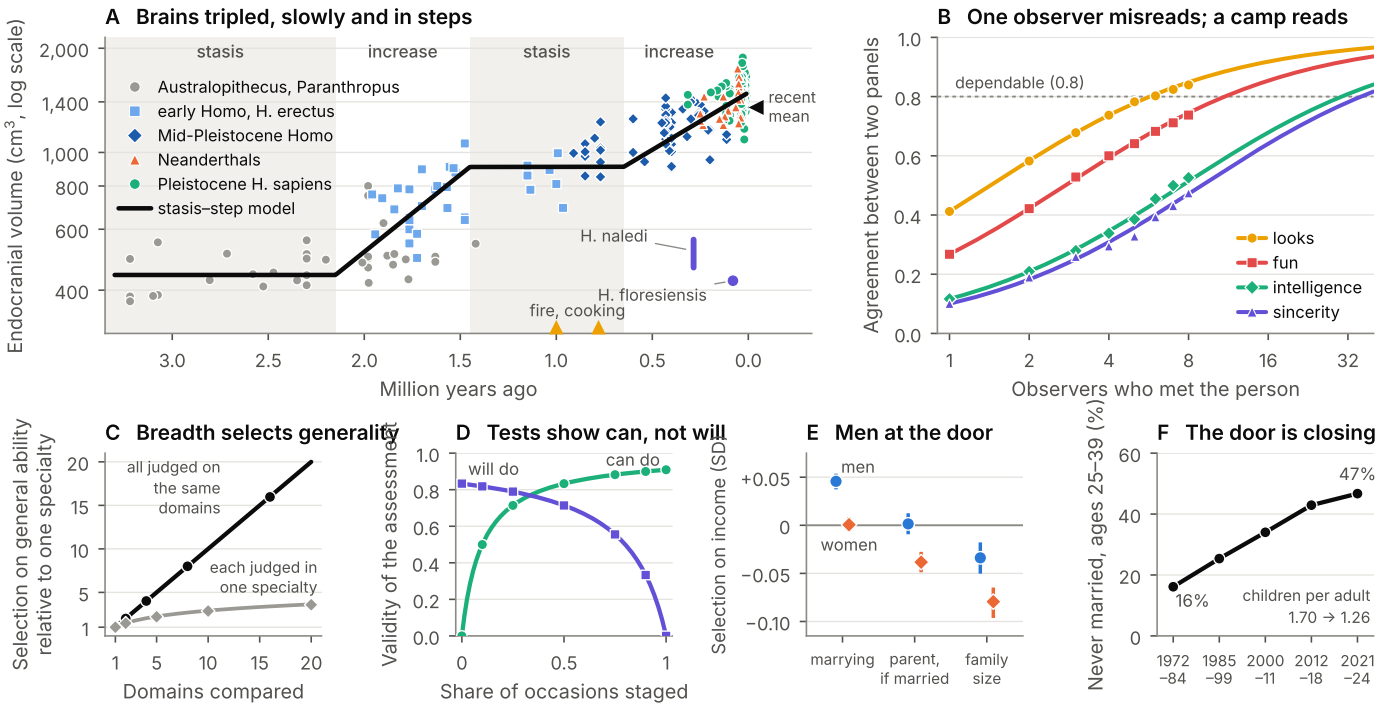
A Brains tripled, slowly and in steps
stasis
increase
stasis
increase
Australopithecus, Paranthropus
early Homo, H. erectus
Mid-Pleistocene Homo
Neanderthals
Pleistocene H. sapiens
stasis–step model
recent mean
H. naledi
H. floresiensis
fire, cooking
Endocranial volume (cm³, log scale)
2,000
1,400
1,000
800
600
400
3.0
2.5
2.0
1.5
1.0
0.5
0.0
Million years ago
B One observer misreads; a camp reads
dependable (0.8)
looks
fun
intelligence
sincerity
Agreement between two panels
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
1
2
4
8
16
32
Observers who met the person
C Breadth selects generality
all judged on the same domains
each judged in one specialty
Selection on general ability relative to one specialty
20
15
10
5
1
1
5
10
15
20
Domains compared
D Tests show can, not will
will do
can do
Validity of the assessment
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
0
0.5
1
Share of occasions staged
E Men at the door
men
women
Selection on income (SD)
+0.05
0
−0.05
−0.10
marrying
parent, if married
family size
F The door is closing
47%
16%
children per adult
1.70 → 1.26
Never married, ages 25–39 (%)
60
40
20
0
1972 –84
1985 –99
2000 –11
2012 –18
2021 –24